

sense, there are times when letting the child play educational games on their own is also advisable. The time when such decisions are to be made differs from child to child, and it is the responsibility of the parent to assess the nature of their child. The type of books the child likes or the types of games she responds to is helpful in this effort. But the final ability and ease of downloading new materials, whether it be books or games or even websites, should be managed from an early age.

The lesson of technology being a privilege and not a right should be clearly communicated to the child. The expectation of owning a tablet, mobile, computer and gaming consoles shouldn't be taken for granted and it is up to the



Play to win at tech

parents to communicate and explain this philosophy to their child. Since kids left unattended are more likely to spend their time aimlessly online or playing games or watching media, the parents have to create an environment where the learnt familiarity of the technology is just another part of the bigger holistic development. This implies no personal technology devices until the child demonstrates the discipline and restraint in their use. If left unmonitored, the persistent use of these devices will distract the child from other wholesome activities such as sports, socialising, interpersonal communication and appreciation for the natural world.

Only during the early periods can parents truly break through the digital noise to have such important lessons heard by their child. The responsibility of which applications are installed on the devices falls directly on the adult, and children shouldn't be given the power to download whatever they wish on to the device. A tech-savvy parent should have a clear record of what activities their child is conducting on these devices. And just like every part of the child's life, there should be clearly established boundaries regarding proper usage and etiquette, otherwise bad habits like being on the device during dinner and not looking at a person while communicating, will build up at an early stage making it harder for mental and social growth during the teenage period.

Apart from the directly proactive role that parents need to play when